



I have an Alma digital import profile that builds new bibs with DC metadata. As with most other import profiles the CSV file holding metadata and other information allows me to specify only two files for import, `file_name_1`, and `file_name_2`. For my oral history objects I use `file_name_1` for my primary MP3 (or MP4) representation, and `file_name_2` for a PDF derivative of the transcribed audio. I would also like to store additional representations holding:

- The transcript as a CSV file,
- An optional WAV file of the recording as a preservation copy, and
- An optional JPG thumbnail of the speaker(s).

How can I import such a record into Alma?

Alma's standard repository import profiles using CSV with Dublin Core (DC) metadata limit you to two file attachments per bibliographic record via the `file_name_1` and `file_name_2` columns. To import oral history records with additional representations like a CSV transcript, optional WAV preservation file, and JPG thumbnail, switch to Alma's Digital Uploader tool for bulk digital ingest, which fully supports this scenario.^{[1] [2]}

Recommended Workflow

Use the Digital Uploader with a CSV metadata file where each row defines one representation (e.g., MP3, PDF, CSV, WAV, JPG). Assign the same `group_id` (a unique identifier like the bib MMS ID or a custom value) across all rows for the same bibliographic record to group multiple representations correctly. Include DC metadata in each row; Alma creates or matches one bib per group with all listed files as representations in the specified collection.^{[3] [1]}

- Prepare files in a folder structure (e.g., one subfolder per bib/group with MP3, PDF, etc.).
- CSV columns include DC fields (e.g., `dc:title`, `dc:creator`), `group_id`, `file_name` (full relative path/label per rep), `label`, usage type (Master/Derivative), etc.
- Create a Digital import profile (under Resources > Import > Manage Import Profiles > Digital type) mapping CSV to DC, specifying the collection and paths.

- Run via Digital Uploader (File > Digital Uploader): upload folder/CSV, select profile, submit ingest job.^[4] ^[1]

CSV Structure Example

group_id	dc:title	dc:creator	file_name	label	usage_type
OH001	Oral History 1	Smith	reps/MP3/OH001.mp3	Primary	Derivative
OH001	Oral History 1	Smith	reps/PDF/OH001.pdf	Transcript PDF	Derivative
OH001	Oral History 1	Smith	reps/CSV/OH001.csv	Transcript CSV	Derivative
OH001	Oral History 1	Smith	reps/WAV/OH001.wav	Preservation	Master
OH001	Oral History 1	Smith	thumbs/OH001.jpg	Thumbnail	Derivative

Optional files (WAV, JPG) can be omitted by excluding their rows.^[1]

Alternatives if Uploader Unavailable

- **Post-import additions:** Import bib + MP3/PDF first, then use "Add Digital Representation" (Resources > Create Inventory) or a follow-up job to attach CSV/WAV/JPG manually/bulk to existing bibs via MMS ID match.^[4]
- Manually edit post-import in Metadata Editor > Digital tab > Manage Representations.

For exact CSV headers and profile setup, check Ex Libris training docs like "Alma Digital: Bulk Workflow - Preparing CSV Files." Do you have access to the Digital Uploader tool? ^[5]

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